

## RECOMMENDATIONS

By

Clifford E. Stone  
SFC, U.S. Army (Ret.)

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During the existence of Project Blue Book, Congress has held several hearings concerning UFO's. However, these hearings were always limited to the records within the Blue Book files and no member of Congress has ever requested to hear testimony from other agencies or individuals, within these other agencies, who have knowledge of the existence of the more involved investigation or interest in the subject of UFO's. The reason for this is very simple. Congress was not made aware of any agency, outside of the U.S. Air Force, as having any interest in the UFO Phenomena.

The release of classified information or material to Congress by any Department of Defense (DOD) agency is made in accordance with Department of Defense Directive 5400.4. However, Congress must identify the information they are seeking in writing. Also, any DOD employee testifying before a congressional committee in executive session in

relation to a classified matter must obtain the assurance of the committee that individuals present have a security clearance commensurate with the highest classification of the information that may be discussed.

This seems to work well for information up to the top secret level. However, it gets much more involved for information protected under Special Access Programs, such as SCI or ESI material.

Department of Defense employees are briefed that members of Congress, by virtue of their elected positions, are not investigated or cleared by the Department of Defense. They are further cautioned, that while members of Congress might be cleared for information up to the top secret level, they may not be cleared for information protected under certain Special Access Programs; information considered as SCI or ESI material; or other information protected by executive directives. This is particularly true of Congressional aids. Therefore, one can easily see the hesitation on the part of some, testifying before Congress, to be less than candid and at times being less than truthful.

Once again the reason for this is simple. While Congress has passed laws to protect so-called whistleblowers, the Congressional track record on protecting whistleblowers has been poor. Therefore, a person testifying before a Congressional committee is much more hesitant to volunteer

any helpful information not asked for. The rule of thumb is; if not asked, don't volunteer information.

Congress should hold a Congressional Committee in executive session to hear testimony concerning the classified aspects of the information that has and is being gathered by the various defense agencies on reported UFO's, as alluded to by the documentation released under FOIA. This committee should also, inquire into the classified aspects of the recovery of "objects of unknown origin" under Project Moondust and Operation Blue Fly. This action would be of great benefit if for nothing more than to insure Congress is made aware of such actions and their intended purpose. While some of the information gathered by this committee could not be made available to the public, as much as possible should be considered for public disclosure.

In order to insure that Congress can accomplish a fair and just hearing; and to insure that all documentation is made available to Congress for review, the following guidelines should be required:

1. The best government documents gathered under FOIA by private researchers should be made available to the Congressional Committee. From these documents the agencies and agencies' employees involved can be ascertained by the retrieval, by the Congressional Committee, of the complete uncensored documents from the agencies in question as

related within the documents themselves.

2. The Congressional Committee should first meet in open session to explain the reasoning for the hearing and open review of the documentation as released under FIOA. This should be done to remove any thought by the public of possible cover up and to assure the public that this is not a search for "little green men" or "flying saucers" hidden away by the military. It should be made clear from the start that the committee is simply looking for the truth behind the alleged cover up and attempting to determine if various agencies were, in fact, withholding information from Congress and the American Public, concerning the UFO Phenomena, in violation of law.

3. The Congressional Committee should follow up the open session with a closed executive session to hear testimony from witnesses within the various agencies involved. This, of course, should be done to protect legitimate national security concerns. It must be understood that while some information of an intelligence interest might initially be reported as UFO's or flying saucers; and reported in some released FOIA documents as such, they could have legitimate national security concerns having nothing to do with the UFO Phenomena itself.

4. Congress must encourage those government employees, testifying before the committee behind closed

doors, to be open and candid in their testimony. This would have to include both active and retired employees. Remember, these people are well aware of the poor record of Congress as to protecting former whistleblowers. Unless there is full assurance that these people will not find themselves losing their jobs and retirement benefits as a result of some drummed-up charges in the future, they will not be as open or candid as they could be.

5. Because of the various agencies involved, every effort should be made to insure that the members, making up the Congressional Committee, have security clearance commensurate with the highest classification of the information that might be discussed. Remember, some of this information will be compartmented and may be considered extremely sensitive information. Having a top secret clearance will not be enough.

6. A final written report should be made by Congress, after the hearings, with as much public disclosure as possible. Remember, the intent of this committee would not be the proving or disproving of the existence of UFO's; but rather, determining if these various agencies have been completely candid and honest with members of Congress, thus demystifying the alleged cover-up of UFO information once and for all.

7. The intent of the Congressional Committee should

simply be to establish the truth as to the alleged cover-up of UFO information by any governmental agency and the legality of any cover-up should it be established that any such cover-up exist.

## SUGGESTED READING LIST

- The Report On Unidentified Flying Objects  
By Edward J. Ruppelt
- The Scientific Study Of Unidentified Flying Objects  
By the University of Colorado
- The UFO Experience; A Scientific Enquiry  
By J. Allen Hynek
- The Hynek UFO Report  
By J. Allen Hynek
- UFOS? YES!; Where The Condon Committee Went Wrong  
By David R. Saunders and R. Roger Harkins
- Challenge To Science: The UFO Enigma  
By Jacques Vallee
- Anatomy Of A Phenomenon  
By Jacques Vallee
- UFOS Explained  
By Philip J. Klass
- UFO Abductions A Dangerous Game  
By Philip J. Klass
- UFOS The Public Deceived  
By Philip J. Klass
- The UFO Casebook  
By Kevin D. Randle
- The October Scenario  
By Kevin D. Randle
- UFO Crash At Roswell  
By Kevin D. Randle and Donald Schmitt
- UFO'S: Let The Evidence Speak For Itself  
By Clifford E. Stone

## LIST OF ORGANIZATION

J. Allen Hynek Center For UFO Studies, 2457 W. Peterson,  
Chicago, IL 60659

Fund For UFO Research, P.O. Box 277, Mount Rainer, MD 20712

Mutual UFO Network, Inc., 103 Oldtowne Road, Seguin, TX  
78155-4099